# ROBERT MERRELL

Healthcare Product Executive | AI-Enabled Portfolios | Product Organization Builder

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## EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Healthcare product executive with 26 years of experience leading product, data, and AI strategy across health systems, payers, life sciences, diagnostics, and digital health. Served as Head of Product and Executive Leadership Team member at Vynca and the American Hospital Association, building product organizations from the ground up and owning portfolio strategy, roadmap, and commercial results. Track record of 8 and 9 figure revenue impact, including $200M+ in added revenue at Invitae, $33M+ at Vynca, and growth from 50 to 800+ hospital clients at Allscripts. Currently leads a certification, education, and technology portfolio at NAHQ while building AI capability across the organization. Equally at home with a board, an investor, or an engineering team, and ready to lead product, portfolio, and AI strategy at the Chief Product Officer level.

| $33M+ | 95% | 65% | 26 Yrs |
|---|---|---|---|
| Revenue driven at VYNCA | AI patient-matching accuracy | Reduction in time-to-market | Experience in healthcare |

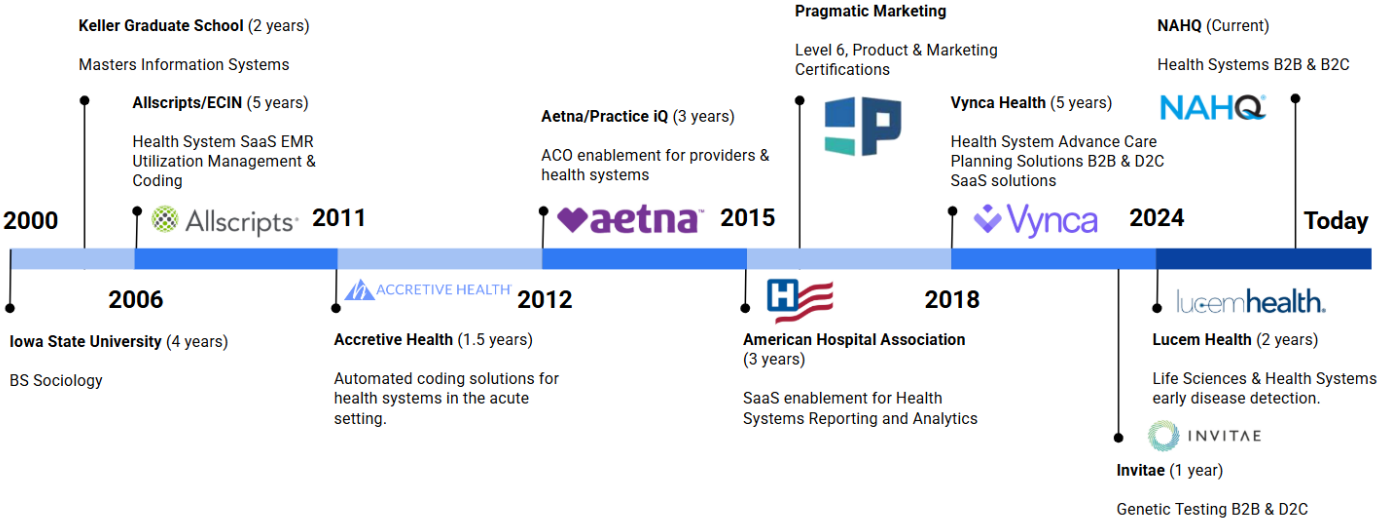
## CORE COMPETENCIES

### Executive Leadership
- P&L Ownership & Financial Acumen
- C-Suite, Board & Investor Communication
- M&A Due Diligence & Product Integration
- Org Design & Team Scaling

### AI & Data Strategy
- AI/ML Product Strategy in Healthcare
- Data Governance, SOC 2, HIPAA, HITRUST
- EMR/EHR Integration (HL7, FHIR, Epic)
- Predictive Analytics & RCM Optimization

### Product & GTM Strategy
- Vision, Roadmap & Portfolio Management
- Go-to-Market Execution & Commercialization
- Market Research & Competitive Intelligence
- MVP Development & Product-Led Growth

### Growth & Customer Success
- Enterprise SaaS Sales Enablement
- Customer Segmentation & Retention
- Outcomes-Driven Product Development
- Regulatory Strategy




## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

### VP of Product & Portfolio Operations | NAHQ, Chicago, IL *2026 – Present*

Leading product and education portfolio strategy for the National Association for Healthcare Quality, partnering with executive leadership to align NAHQ's certification, education, and technology offerings with its strategic alliance with the Joint Commission.

- Own end-to-end product and portfolio operations across a 200+ piece learning content library, 6 certifications, and 4 programs including Learning Labs and NAHQ Next annual conference.
- Driving B2C portfolio growth alongside B2B product innovation initiatives aimed at accelerating workforce capability in healthcare quality.
- Spearheading AI organizational enablement across Copilot, Copilot Studio, and Claude Code, building internal AI capability for both NAHQ staff and healthcare enterprise users to advance quality improvement outcomes.

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### Director of Product Management | Lucem Health, Raleigh, NC *2024 – 2026*

Led product strategy for AI-driven predictive analytics platforms serving health systems and life sciences organizations. Mapped longitudinal patient pathways pre- and post-diagnosis to power early intervention workflows and value-based care programs.

- Architected direct-to-consumer and AI-driven clinical workflows achieving 60% patient engagement — exceeding industry benchmarks by 2x.
- Launched strategic market expansions generating $10M+ in incremental annual revenue across arrhythmia, oncology, and GLP-1 therapeutic areas.
- Defined scalable product vision across multiple disease states by synthesizing data analytics, qualitative market research, and clinical user feedback.

### Director of Product Management | Invitae, San Francisco, CA *2023 – 2024*

Owned end-to-end product strategy for billing optimization and EMR workflow automation within a $1B+ genetic information company. Delivered AI/ML-powered clinical integrations that redefined provider experience and reimbursement efficiency.

- Drove $200M+ in additional revenue through AI/ML test order efficiencies, automated billing workflows, and EMR optimization across major health systems.
- Built and launched Epic Aura bi-directional integrations enabling provider-centric genetic testing workflows, achieving 15% growth in health system adoption within six months.
- Led cross-functional teams across product, engineering, clinical affairs, and sales to deliver compliant, interoperable healthcare solutions at scale.

### Director of Product Management & Development (Head of Product) | Vynca, Palo Alto, CA *2018 – 2023*

Served as Head of Product and Executive Leadership Team member for a digital health startup focused on Advance Care Planning. Built the product organization from the ground up and drove full-cycle product development across a HIPAA-compliant SaaS platform.

- Achieved a 73% digital completion rate for Advance Care Planning patient centric workflows — a leading outcome metric in the space — through user-centered design and behavioral health principles.
- Designed and launched a self-service SaaS platform that reduced average customer implementation time by approximately 2 months, accelerating time-to-value and improving NPS.
- Maintained ISO, SOC 2, HITRUST, and HIPAA compliance across all business units while contributing to fundraising strategy and investor communications as an Executive Leadership Team member.

### Director of Product & Data (Head of Product) | American Hospital Association, Chicago, IL *2015 – 2018*

Led product, data, and analytics strategy for Health Forum, a $200M for-profit subsidiary of the AHA serving 12,000+ hospital executives. Member of the Executive Leadership Team.

- Achieved 94% reduction in operating expenses within 6 months by consolidating data infrastructure into an integrated platform for workflow optimization and enterprise reporting.
- Delivered an enterprise data warehouse, fully responsive reporting system, and digital migration of flagship publications to 12,000+ health system decision-makers.
- Contributed to organizational strategy, product portfolio planning, and growth initiatives as a standing member of the Executive Leadership Team.

### Director of Product Management & Development | Aetna – Practice iQ, Hartford, CT *2012 – 2015*

Incubated a value-based care product business unit within Aetna ($63B), standing up Practice iQ to support independent providers transitioning from fee-for-service to value-based reimbursement models.

- Designed and scaled a multi-partner business model leveraging Aetna Analytics, Active Health Management, CVS, and Walgreens to deliver integrated technology and consulting services.
- Reduced development expenses by 60% through strategic offshore team transitions while simultaneously expanding product capabilities.
- Built high-trust executive client relationships resulting in sustained customer retention and new market penetration across independent practice networks.

### Manager of Technology & Product Development | Accretive Health, Chicago, IL *2011 – 2012*

Managed SaaS/services clinical recommendation platform for 200+ employed physicians and 400+ hospital clients, spanning four product lines focused on denial reduction and billing integrity.

- Achieved 380% client growth in under 18 months, expanding from 20 to 400 clients; launched three additional products generating $15M in new revenue.
- Led end-to-end product development for the Physician Advisory Services division using agile methodologies across integrated offshore and onshore teams.

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**Manager of Solutions Management** | Allscripts (ECIN), Chicago, IL *2006 – 2011*

Drove post-merger growth of ECIN's client base and revenue following acquisition by Allscripts, expanding from 50 to 800+ hospital clients and growing revenue from $3M to $120M.

- Designed and launched SaaS solutions for discharge planning, utilization management, and CDI generating $2M in year-one revenue and $460K in recurring revenue within two quarters.
- Secured strategic partnerships with 3M, Optum360, and McKesson; achieved 98% client retention over six years and added 150 net-new health system clients.

## EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

**M.S., Information Systems Management** – Keller Graduate School, Chicago, IL *2002 – 2004*

**B.S., Sociology** – Iowa State University, Ames, IA *1996 – 2000*

*Minors:* Child & Family Services, Family & Financial Services, Therapy & Counseling (Certified)

**Pragmatic Marketing Certified – Level VI** – Pragmatic Institute (Product Management & Marketing), Chicago, IL *2016 – 2018*